Nishal Stanislaus Silva, *PhD*

Applied AI Engineer | Computer Vision, Generative AI, Production ML Deployment | Applied ML

Canadian Permanent Resident, Eligible to work in Canada without sponsorship

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18th October 2026

Re: Applied AI Engineer (Forward Deployed) – Nexxa.AI

Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the Applied AI Engineer (Forward Deployed) role at Nexxa.AI. I am a Machine Learning Engineer with a PhD (University of Trento, 2025) and 10+ years across industry and academia, and I build end-to-end ML systems that run in production. At MAS Holdings I led computer vision systems for manufacturing, including care-label inspection that cut inspection time by 99.5% and raised operational efficiency by up to 300%. Turning a real operational workflow into a deployed ML system for industry is the work I have done at MAS, and it is what this role asks for.

Three parts of your posting match my work directly. For computer vision, I built OpenCV-based defect detection and inspection systems at MAS, taking a care-label checker from a flatbed scanner to an industrial camera with a conveyor and PLC reject, and a loom-side fabric detector on a camera array. For deployment, my published system runs at 14 ms on a Raspberry Pi 4, 74x faster than the DTW baseline (Journal of the Audio Engineering Society, 2026), and I owned its full lifecycle from data acquisition to monitoring. For customer-facing delivery, I was a technical consultant at Forestpin, turning compliance and risk requirements into technical specs and deployed pipelines, and at MAS I defined scope and milestones with product and operations stakeholders.

I should be direct about the gaps. My generative AI work is applied, covering LLM and RAG tooling and a LoRA fine-tune of a music generation model, rather than production LLM products for enterprise customers. I have deployed with Docker and AWS and know Kubernetes only at a working level, and I have not used GCP or Azure in production, and I have not used YOLO, SAM or DETR in production. I expect to pick these up quickly. I would like to understand the travel expectations in more detail.

I am a Canadian permanent resident based in Toronto, ON, eligible to work without sponsorship, and available immediately. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my experience in computer vision and production ML can support the forward deployed team at Nexxa.AI. My portfolio, publications and open datasets are available at nishal.xyz.

Sincerely,

Nishal Stanislaus Silva, PhD